

1.3: THE IMPORTANCE OF AUDIENCE AND PURPOSE

Audience: Before one begins the process of communication one must ask few questions to oneself. 'Why am I communicating?', 'With whom I am going to communicate?' the obvious answer is we are going to communicate with another human being like us not with animals. Whether we are trying to persuade, command, motivate, and entertain or to train we are communicating with an audience. The sole purpose of our communication revolves round the audience. Our communication should always strive to be audience oriented, for the process of communication to be successful and complete. We must understand that without the receiver's attention and interest the process will fail. The sender must give due importance to the receiver. Before beginning the process of communication the sender must clear the objective of the communication in his mind. Then only, he will be able to make it clear to the audience (receiver). The sender must keep the following things in mind to keep the communication audience specific.

- i) Always respect the receiver's point of view.
- ii) Sender must know receiver's interests, tastes, preferences, background, education, culture etc. in advance.
- iii) Never underestimate the receiver. There must be a sense of respect for the receiver (vice-versa).
- iv) Communication should be a collaborative activity between sender and receiver.
- v) Effective planning is required. The planning involves 3 things.
 - a) Language skills and intelligence,
 - b) Knowledge and understanding of the topic/subject and
 - c) relationship/rapport enjoyed by both the sender and receiver with each other.

Purpose: As we have already discussed in the previous chapters that communication is a human need. Communication is instrumental or directly satisfies certain needs like physical, emotional, social, psychological etc... For that reason each and every communication has a definite purpose. The purpose is linked with both the sender and the receiver. Without purpose any communication can be rendered useless. A statement of purpose not only describes what we want to accomplish, but also helps us know at the end of the communication whether it has been achieved. The purpose can be classified into two broad categories. I.e. General or specific. General purposes can be to entertain, to inform, to attract, to regulate, to instruct etc... Specific purposes involve to influence, to motivate, to enquire, to persuade etc... The listeners of communication plays an important role in the communication process because they influence the medium of communication. When communication is targeted towards audience with a purpose it yields desired result. We must understand that some purposes are sender related and some purposes are receiver related.

To inform: Any sentence that is informative in nature. e.g. i) this road leads to the main hall of the compound. ii) I'm a student of IST year B.Tech from CET.

To entertain: Cracking a joke or delivering a dialogue which amuses the audience or listeners.

To attract: In this purpose the listeners or audience or receivers are attracted to listen or give attention to the speaker. The listeners might not have a direct interest or role in what the sender is telling but the communication is such designed that they get attracted. Advertisement hoardings, Ads in TV channels.

To regulate: This purpose generally serves rules and regulations, sometimes maintaining discipline in a particular environment. No smoking here.

To instruct: This purpose has a greater role in training, teaching, directing, and administrating.

To influence: This purpose is specific in nature, where we try to influence an individual's decision, attitude, thought and impression.

To motivate: This purpose gives attention to particular individual or group to get some work done or to do better in life, like sermonizing etc.

To persuade: Here the sender is trying to extract some work or job by continuously involving in conversation with the receiver. This purpose require a lot of skills. This may also take some time to get fulfilled.

To enquire: When we try to extract information from someone on a specific issue or with a specific motif we use this purpose. What is your name? Where do you read? etc...

Human beings are social beings. Though we claim that we cannot exist without communication but in reality we use communication for achieving our own selfish motifs. Hence, we may conclude that all communication taking place in this world revolves around some purpose or the other.
